17

BASIC BODICE BLOCK

17.1 INTRODUCTION

The bodice block is of great importance in dress designing. This paper pattern is made with standard ease or looseness for standard measurements or for individual measurements. This does not contain any allowances for seams, overlap, turning, etc. The bodice block is made upto the waist only. The paper pattern for any garment can be made with the help of the bodice block pattern. The bodice block pattern for ladies and children's garments is made separately for upper and lower body. The dress block pattern for men's garments is made for upper body and lower body - e.g. shirt pattern and pant pattern.

17.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- state the characteristics of bodice block;
- explain the different types of bodice block;
- adapt a bodice block and state its advantages;

17.3 BODICE BLOCK

The bodice block can be made either with standard or with individual measurements. The markings for darts, balance, grainline, etc. are placed on it. A standard looseness is kept but no allowance for seams, overlap or turning is marked. The bodice block is then cut on thin muslin or new markin cloth and draped over the dummy to check for correctness.

Thereafter, the paper pattern for the garment is made after adding the requisite looseness to the block pattern.

17.4 TYPES OF BODICE BLOCK

There are many types of bodice blocks:-

1. Child's basic bodice block

i) Basic bodice block

These are made according to a child's measurements. They very with age. In the basic bodice block for children aged 1-3 years, the front portion is kept slightly larger as children of this age group have a protruding abdomen. The bodice block made for older children is different. The garment pattern is made with the help of the basic block, e.g. - top, shirt, T-shirt, etc.

ii) Sleeve block

The sleeve block is made in accordance with the bodice block. Modifications can be made in the sleeve block according to the kind of sleeve desired in the garment.

iii) Skirt block

A fit block is made for girls skirts. This can also be adapted according to the design of the skirt.

2. Bodice block for ladies

i) Basic block

This block is made according to measurements and with the standard looseness. It differs with measurements and with age. It can be manipulated to suit individual requirements e.g. dart manipulation, fitting according to the figure and changes according to the dress, e.g. - 'A' line suit, kalidaar suit, middi, etc.

ii) Sleeve block

The sleeve block is made according to the basic block. It can be manipulated to give fit or loose sleeve according to the fashion. It can also be adapted to make different designs in sleeves.

iii) Block for pyjamas - pant

The trouser block can be made according to given measurements and also manipulated according to designs, jeans, bellbottom, etc.

In this way, the basic block can be made and then adapted according to the desired design. Hence it becomes essential to know about the basic bodice block, only then will we be able to use it properly.

17.5 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the basic bodice block and its type.

Do and see

Adapt a bodice block.

17.6 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Describe a bodice block and explain what it is used for.